

4.6 Issues and debates	Examples of issues and debates in learning theories: • Ethics (e.g. the ethical issues involved in using animals in studies). • Practical issues in the design and implementation of research (e.g. generalising from animal-study findings to humans). • Reductionism (in the way behaviourism reduces behaviour into parts to be studied). • Comparisons between ways of explaining behaviour using different themes (e.g. different learning theories). • Psychology as a science (e.g. in the methodology; in the explicit focus of behaviourism on the measurable). • Culture (e.g. relates to reinforcement patterns in learning theory as well as social learning theory and what is modelled) and gender (e.g. if used in the practical research exercise, and in observational learning issues). • Nature-nurture (e.g. in the observations if looking at gender or age or characteristics as these can be learned or biologically given). • An understanding of how psychological understanding has developed over time (e.g. can come through choice of study, such as if looking at video game violence or through current therapy practice). • Issues of social control (e.g. use of learning theories in therapy can be social control, including issues of power of the therapist). • The use of psychological knowledge within society (e.g. using patterns of reward to shape behaviour in schools or prisons). • Issues related to socially sensitive research (e.g. issues of the power of the therapist).
--------------------------------------	--